

FinOps Maturity Self-Assessment

A 10-question diagnostic to map where your cloud cost practice stands today – and what it would take to get to the next level. Based on the FinOps Foundation's Crawl / Walk / Run framework, adapted for Indian SMBs and mid-market teams.

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How it works

10 questions. Pick one answer per question. Add up your score. Read your maturity band at the end. Each band has a one-page action plan.

Should take you 5 minutes.

The 10 questions

1. Who owns cloud cost in your org?

- 0. No one explicitly. Finance gets the bill.
- 1. Finance owns the bill, engineering owns the build, no one bridges them.
- 2. DevOps/SRE keeps an eye on it informally.
- 3. Designated FinOps lead or cost-owner with a calendar slot.

2. How is cost data shared?

- 0. Monthly bill from AWS/Azure/GCP, finance stares at it.
- 1. Quarterly cost review presentation, leadership audience.
- 2. Weekly dashboard accessible to engineering.
- 3. Real-time cost-per-service or cost-per-team visible in Slack/Teams or in a dashboard everyone bookmarks.

3. Tagging coverage

- 0. Untagged or inconsistent.
- 1. Some resources tagged, some not.
- 2. Mandatory tags for new resources but legacy is messy.
- 3. 90% of resources tagged with `env`, `owner`, `service`, `cost_center`.
Untagged → flagged automatically.

4. Anomaly detection

- 0. We notice when the bill comes in.
- 1. We notice when finance escalates.

- 2. We have AWS/Azure native anomaly alerts going to a channel no one watches.
- 3. Anomaly alerts route to the team that owns the affected service, with SLA to triage.

5. Reserved Instance / Savings Plan strategy

- 0. None. All on-demand.
- 1. Bought RIs once, haven't reviewed since.
- 2. Annual review of RI/SP coverage tied to a baseline.
- 3. Continuous coverage management; coverage rate tracked as KPI.

6. Right-sizing cadence

- 0. Never.
- 1. Once after migration, never since.
- 2. Quarterly review.
- 3. Continuous: Compute Optimizer / OpenCost recommendations actioned monthly.

7. Engineering accountability

- 0. Engineers don't know what their workloads cost.
- 1. Costs surfaced in retros sometimes.
- 2. Each team has a monthly cost budget.
- 3. Cost-per-feature or cost-per-tenant is a tracked product KPI.

8. Showback / chargeback

- 0. None.
- 1. Informal showback at all-hands.
- 2. Formal showback report by team / product / customer.
- 3. Real chargeback to business unit budgets.

9. Forecast accuracy (last 3 months)

- 0. We don't forecast.
- 1. Forecasts are off by >25%.
- 2. Forecasts within 10-25%.
- 3. Forecasts within 5-10%, variances explained.

10. Tooling

- 0. Nothing beyond the cloud provider's billing console.
- 1. Native tools (AWS Cost Explorer, Azure Cost Mgmt) used regularly.
- 2. Open-source tools deployed (OpenCost, Infracost) but not universally used.
- 3. Mature stack: OpenCost + Infracost in CI + FOCUS-conformant exports + custom dashboards. Or paid tooling fully adopted.

Score yourself

Add up your score (0-30).

0-8 – Crawl

You're in good company – most Indian SMBs are here. Cloud is treated as an infrastructure cost, not a managed product. Quick wins available everywhere. The next 60 days could deliver 20-30% savings with no architectural changes.

What to do first (in this order): 1. Pick one person as the cost owner (even part-time). 2. Tag everything. Mandate tags for new resources via SCP/policy. 3. Turn on AWS Cost Anomaly Detection (free) or Azure equivalent. Route alerts to a channel. 4. Pull a 30-day spend report. Find the top 5 waste items. Fix them. 5. After fixing, look at RI/SP coverage. Don't commit until baseline is stable.

9-17 – Walk

You have visibility but the muscle isn't built yet. Costs are tracked but not driving behavior. Engineers know costs exist but don't own them. This is where most teams plateau.

What to do first: 1. Move from monthly cost reviews to weekly cost dashboards engineers actually look at. 2. Set per-team or per-product cost budgets. Make finance owner of the conversation, engineering owner of the lever. 3. Get RI/SP coverage to a measured KPI (e.g. "70% Compute SP coverage on prod"). 4. Adopt OpenCost (CNCF) for Kubernetes if applicable. Free. 5. Run quarterly architectural reviews focused on cost – not "review my Terraform" but "what would this cost if we 10x'd traffic."

18-24 – Run

You have a real practice. Cost is part of how engineering thinks. Forecasts are reliable. The opportunity now is sharpening: cost-per-tenant, cost-per-customer, or cost-as-a-product-KPI.

What to do first: 1. Build cost-per-feature or cost-per-tenant attribution. Hard but transformative. 2. Move forecasts under 10% variance. 3. Engage product management – make pricing and packaging decisions with cost as input. 4. Consider FinOps Foundation membership for community + benchmarking. 5. Train a second person in FinOps so it's not a single point of failure.

25-30 – Lead

Rare for Indian SMBs. You're operating ahead of most enterprises. The remaining ground is around AI/ML cost (rapidly growing), sustainability/carbon, and possibly multi-cloud cost normalization (FOCUS spec).

What to do first: 1. Adopt FOCUS-conformant exports across clouds. Normalize for analysis. 2. Build AI/ML-specific FinOps practice (GPU utilization, model serving cost-per-request). 3. Consider sharing your story externally – case studies, conference talks. It pays back in hiring. 4. Mentor adjacent teams; don't let the practice be a single hero.

What if I want help getting to the next level?

This self-assessment was honest if you scored honestly. The next 60 days of improvement are usually cheap and high-impact for anyone scoring under 20. After that, structural change matters more than tooling.

Free 30-min Cloud Cost Health Check: Bring your assessment score and a recent CUR sample. We'll spend 30 minutes on the highest-ROI moves you could make this quarter. You leave with a written summary, even if we never work together.

[Book your call →](#)

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